

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's take a trip down the Amazon River!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How important is the Amazon rainforest for the environment? Why?
- What can people do to help save endangered species and ecosystems?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings and impressions.
- I can exchange opinions.
- I can express complex statements using words like *who*, *that* or *which*.





Let's Explore!

Sally finds out about the dangers that the planet's **green lungs*** are facing.

* The Amazon Forest is the Earth's largest ecosystem and allows plants to produce oxygen for the whole planet.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sally: Jennifer Andrews, you are a biology teacher and an activist involved in the preservation of the Amazonian rainforest. What was the factor that started it all?

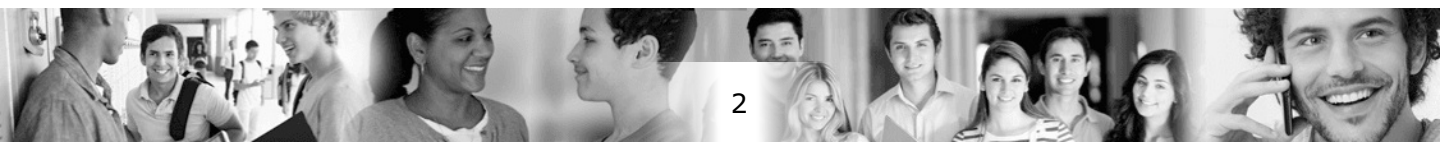
Jennifer Andrews: I read so much about it. I've always dreamed of sailing down the Amazon River and being surrounded by the rainforest. I wanted to experience the emotions that explorers felt as they walked through the thick foliage for the first time.

Sally: Were you inspired by the writings of the scientists who explored the forest before you?

Jennifer Andrews: Absolutely. The first book about the rainforest was written in 1542 by a Spanish explorer. This is the book which I found most inspiring.

Sally: What made you decide to become an activist?

Jennifer Andrews: As I was surfing around the Internet, I stumbled upon many websites that advocate rainforest conservation. I found out that many species were threatened by human activity. What I didn't realize was that the companies that are cutting down the trees for the logging industry might completely destroy the forest by the year 2030. The rainforest was created by nature to clean the air that we breathe.





Let's Practice!

Sally asks Jennifer Andrews what compelled her to protect the environment.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete them by selecting the correct answer. Use: threatened, inspiring, realize, compelled, inspired.

- 1) Were you _____ by the writings of the scientists who explored the forest before you? (inspired / inspiring / inspiration)
- 2) This is the book which I found most _____. (inspired / inspiring / inspiration)
- 3) I felt _____ to join an organization that would try to make a difference. (compelling / compelled / compel)
- 4) I found out that many species were _____ by human activity. (threatening / threatened / threaten)
- 5) What I didn't _____ was that the companies that are cutting down the trees for the logging industry might completely destroy the forest by the year 2030. (realize / realizing / realized)



Let's Practice!

Jennifer Andrews explains who inspired her to be an activist!

Instructions: Underline all the incorrect words in each sentence.

- 1) The first book about the rainforest was written in 1542 by a Spanish explorer. This is the book where I found most inspiring.
- 2) I wanted to experience the emotions when explorers felt as they walked through the thick foliage for the first time.
- 3) I stumbled upon many websites who advocate rainforest conservation.
- 4) What I didn't realize was that the companies who are cutting down the trees for the logging industry might completely destroy the forest by the year 2030.
- 5) Were you inspired by the writings of the scientists which explored the forest before you?





Extension Activity

Talk about your favorite person.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Pick two people who mean a lot to you.
- Think of some feelings and impressions these people bring to mind when you think of them.
- Write a paragraph, 5 to 6 sentences, about each person.
- Use complex sentences with connectors like *that*, *which* and *who*, to provide information in an interesting way.
- Compare with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about feelings and impressions.

☐ ☐

I exchange opinions.

☐ ☐

I express complex statements using words like *who*, *that* or *which*.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to stumble upon** (verb): to discover by chance
e.g. I stumbled upon many websites that advocate the protection of the environment.
- **conservation** (noun): the action of protecting the environment
e.g. I stumbled upon many websites that advocate nature conservation.
- **rainforest** (noun): a dense tropical forest rich in biodiversity
e.g. I stumbled upon many websites that advocate rainforest conservation.
- **logging** (noun): the business of cutting trees for profit
e.g. The companies that are cutting down the trees for the logging industry might completely destroy the forest by the year 2030.
- **thick** (adjective): dense, showing a great amount of something
e.g. The first scientists explored the thick Amazonian rainforest in 1542.
- **foliage** (noun): plants and leaves, collectively
e.g. I wanted to experience the emotions that explorers felt as they walked through the thick foliage for the first time.





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive

When you are writing a news article or giving an interview, you can include the Simple Past Passive to describe something done by someone at sometime in the past.

In a regular sentence structure, you use Subject + verb + object.

Example:

A Spanish explorer wrote the first book about the rainforest.

In the Simple Past Passive form, you use the structure:

Object + *was / were* + past participle + *by* Subject

Example:

The first book about the rainforest was written in 1542 by a Spanish explorer.

You can use the Simple Past Passive to ask questions:

***Was / Were* + Object + past participle + *by* Subject**

Example:

Were you inspired by the writings of the scientists who explored the forest before you?



Learning Points

Subject and Object Relative Clauses

When you want to clarify which person or thing you are talking about, you use a relative clause.

You can begin a relative clause with *who* for people, *which* for things or *that* for either people or things.

In spoken English you usually use *that*, rather than *which* or *who*.

You put the relative clause immediately after the noun it talks about.

A subject relative clause describes the subject of the clause.

Example:

The man who called wanted to speak to Tom.

Which man? The man who called.

The clause *who called* immediately follows man - the noun it describes.

An object relative clause describes the object of the clause.

Example:

Can you return the book that I lent you?

Which book? The book I lent you.

Example	Clause	Relative Pronoun	Type of Relative Clause
<i>This is the book which I found most inspiring.</i>	which I found most inspiring	which	object
<i>Were you inspired by the writings of the scientists who explored the forest before you?</i>	who explored the forest	who	subject
<i>What was the factor that started it all?</i>	that started it all	that	subject
<i>I wanted to experience the emotions that explorers felt.</i>	that explorers felt	that	object

